

Security, costs, and ownership

How the FASTR platform protects a country's data — and what it takes to run it

»» FASTR Useful Data

Data security

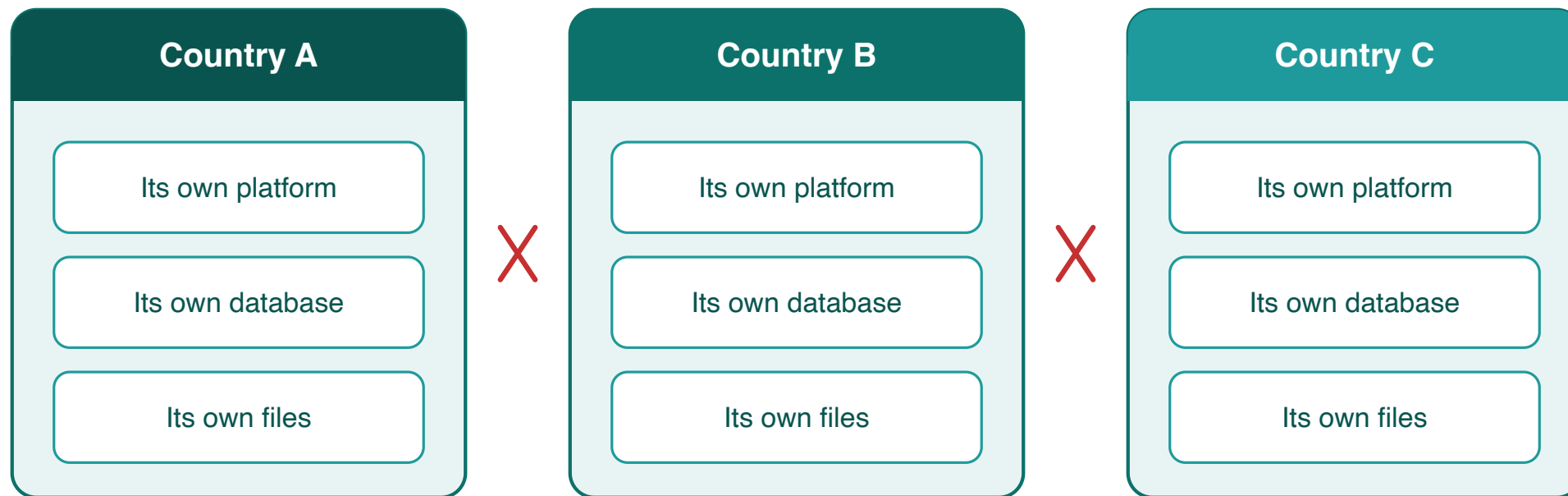
The background is a solid teal color. On the right side, there are several overlapping geometric shapes. These include a large dark teal quarter-circle in the top right, a smaller dark teal quarter-circle in the bottom left, and two sets of concentric circles. One set of circles is centered near the bottom right, and another set is centered near the top right. The circles are a lighter shade of teal and overlap with the other shapes.

What the platform holds

- **Monthly service totals per facility** — for example, 45 first antenatal visits at one clinic in March
- The **same figures as the DHIS2 reports** the ministry already produces
- **No patient records** — no names, no addresses, nothing individual

Each country is fully separate

Sharing between countries is not restricted — it is **technically impossible**. Each country runs its own installation.



No connection between countries — by design

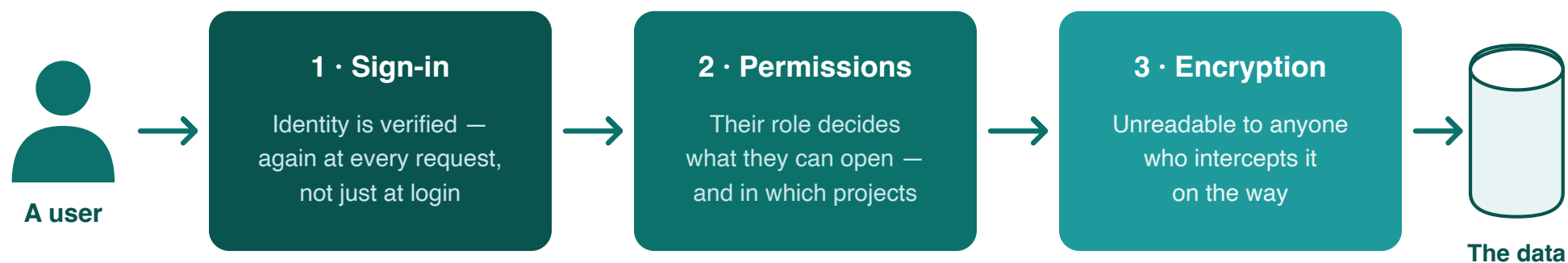
Who can see what

- The ministry decides **who gets an account**, and each person's role
- Roles set what a person can do — **view, edit, or administer** — and in which projects
- Identity is **re-checked on every request**, not just at login
- Only a **small, named group of administrators** can change the setup

How the data is protected

The platform checks who you are at every step, makes everything unreadable while it travels, and keeps automatic backup copies.

Three checks stand between a user and the data

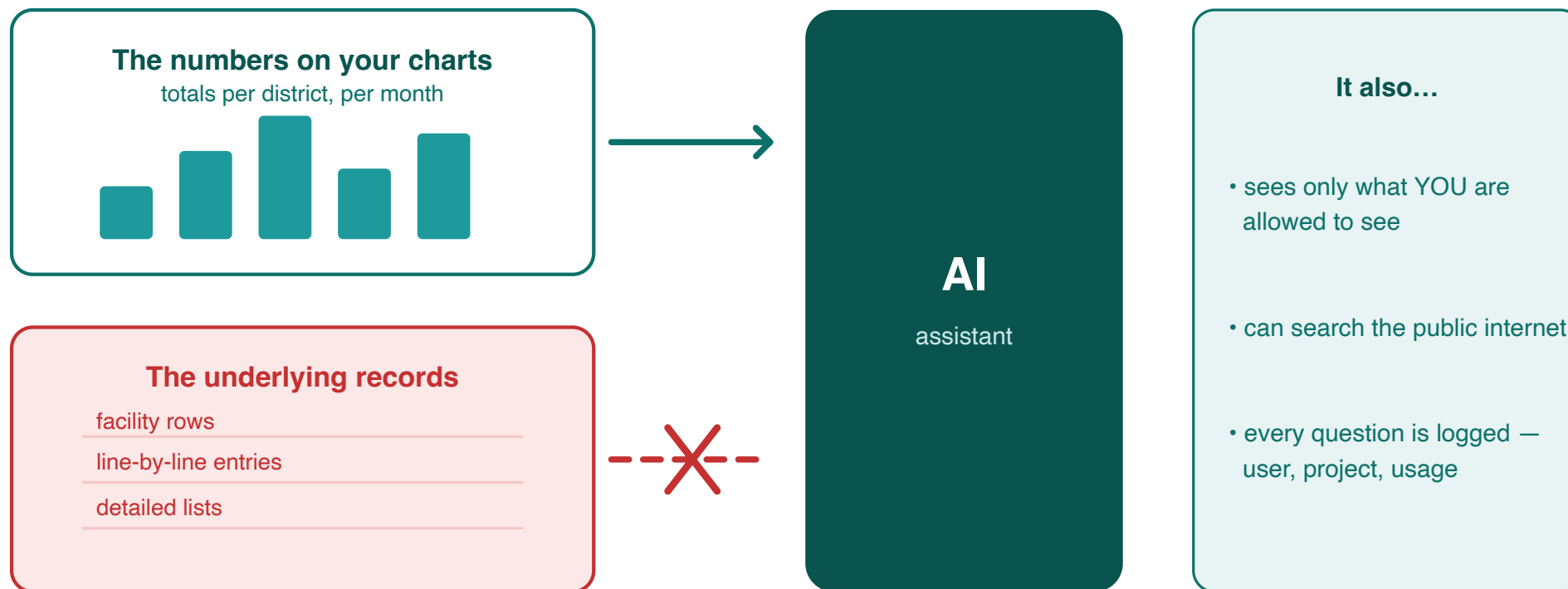


Separately: protection against loss

The database is backed up every 30 minutes, the full installation daily — if a server fails, everything can be rebuilt

What the AI can see

Aggregated totals only — the numbers a user could already see on screen, within that user's permissions.
Never the underlying rows.



Costs and ownership

The background features a solid teal color. On the right side, there are abstract geometric elements: a large dark teal quarter-circle in the top right, a dark teal rectangle below it, and two sets of concentric circles in the bottom right, one in dark teal and one in a lighter teal shade.

Running costs

Three lines: **server hosting** (fixed), **AI use** (metered), **maintenance** (shared team). No license fees, no per-user fees — the software is open source.



Planning estimates, 2026 prices — no license fees, no per-user charges

The figures — planning estimates

Estimates at 2026 prices and today's usage. **Not a quote.**

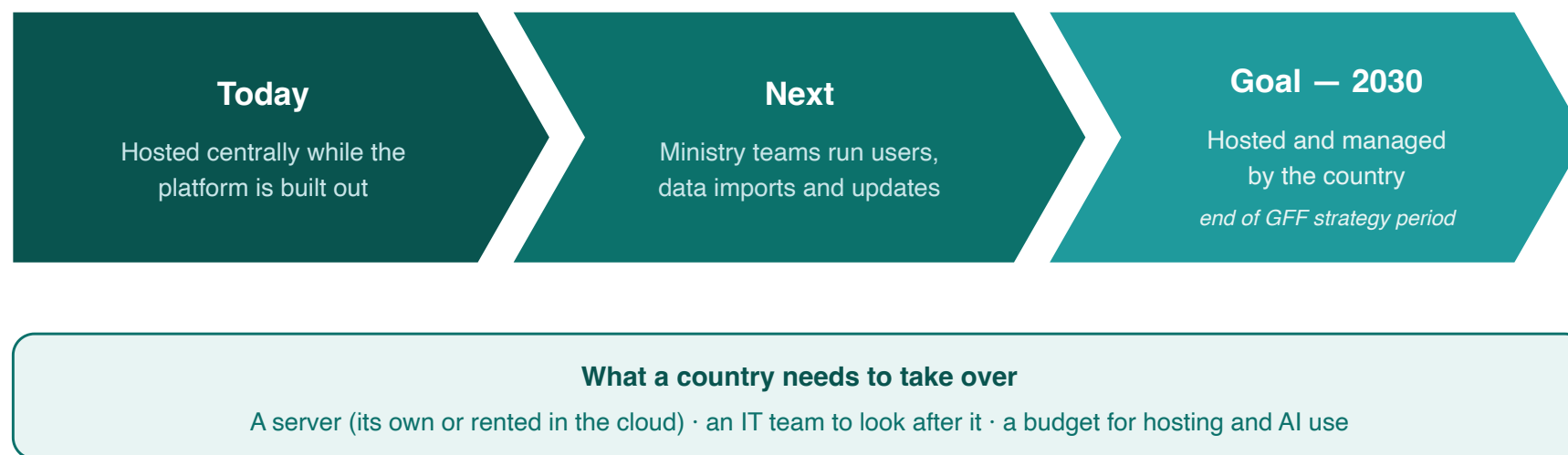
- **Hosting** a country's instance: about **USD 500–800 per year** — larger countries toward the top
- **AI use**: about **USD 350 per month** (~USD 4,000 per year) for a typical country; the largest countries several times this, and it grows with use
- **Shared platform maintenance** (engineering, monitoring, backups): roughly **USD 7,000–10,000 per country per year** today — it falls as more countries join
- **Optional support** (data refresh, quality checks, analysis): about **USD 5,000–15,000 per year**, depending on level
- **Total: about USD 12,000 per year** — up to USD 20,000–30,000 with support

Hosting — today and tomorrow

- Hosted **centrally today**, while the platform is in active development — every country receives fixes and new features the same day
- Built **portable**: the same platform can run on a ministry's own servers
- **Moving later requires no rebuild** — the same software runs in either place
- **All of a country's data can be exported in full at any time**, now or later, regardless of hosting

The path to country ownership

For countries who do want to host themselves, there will be effort required from the Ministry of Health. A team will need to run servers, backups, and upgrades; and procurement in place for hosting and for AI services, which are bought from a commercial provider (e.g. Anthropic, OpenAI).



The essentials

- **Monthly totals only** — never patient records
- **One installation per country** — no pathway between countries
- **About USD 12,000 per year** to run — hosting, metered AI, shared maintenance; no license or per-user fees
- **Country hosting by 2030** — the stated transition goal

Technical annex — for IT and DHIS2 teams

Architecture and isolation

- Each country instance is a **separate Docker deployment**: its own application container, its own **PostgreSQL** database, its own **Valkey** cache, its own storage volume, on a private network
- Within an instance, each project has its **own database** (`project_{uuid}`) for authoring content
- Computed results live in **versioned results packages** (parquet files, queried via DuckDB) — projects read the package attached to them, never each other's

Authentication and access control

- Identity is managed by **Clerk** (managed identity provider); session claims are **verified by middleware on every request** — auth bypass exists only for local development and is disabled in production
- **Two-tier RBAC**: instance-level permissions plus per-project roles resolved from the database on each request
- Server access: **SSH by cryptographic key only**, restricted to two named engineers — no password login

Data protection and operations

- **TLS terminates at nginx**, certificates provisioned and auto-renewed via certbot; secrets are injected as environment variables at runtime — never in images, never sent to the browser
- **R analysis modules run in ephemeral containers** (removed on completion) that mount only their own run's sandbox directory
- Backups: **pg_dump every 30 minutes** (3-day rolling window) plus **volume snapshots daily / weekly / monthly**; restores are permission-gated (`can_restore_backups`) and require a server-held key on top of a valid session

AI integration, precisely

- Claude (Anthropic) is reached through a **server-side proxy**; the API key never leaves the server
- Tool calls run **inside the user's authenticated session** — the AI holds no permissions of its own
- Data tools return **aggregated metric outputs only**: there is **no facility-identifier dimension** in the query interface, and any dimension with more than 20 values is summarized as a count
- **Server-side web search/fetch (Anthropic-hosted) is enabled** in the project chat for general questions
- Every request is logged (user, project, model, tokens); **daily per-user and weekly per-instance limits** are enforced

Data and interoperability

- Source data: **aggregated DHIS2 numerators** (facility-month service counts) — imported server-side, with per-(indicator, month) replace semantics and a per-indicator import ledger
- **Full export at any time**: a country's data and results can be exported regardless of hosting arrangement
- The codebase is **open source**: github.com/FASTR-Analytics/platform